

INVESTOR PITCH · 2026

kern.

Find your direction by doing real work.

Manuel Di Paolo · Founder



THE PROBLEM

Capable people are unsure, and the door in is *narrowing*.

2 in 3

of 18 to 30 year-olds are unsure about their career path

Tallo, May 2025 (US): nearly 2 in 3.

74%

of young people lack access to a mentor

Big Brothers Big Sisters / Harris Poll, 2025.

-35%

entry-level job postings since early 2023

Job-posting data since 2023, secondary summaries.

WHY NOW

Employers want proof of skills. AI lets a beginner *make real work*.

70%

use skills-based hiring
for entry-level roles

NACE 2026. Yet under 1 in 700 new hires at firms that dropped degree rules lacks a degree.

43%

of employed new graduates are underemployed

IBISWorld and secondary summaries. The first rung is harder to reach.

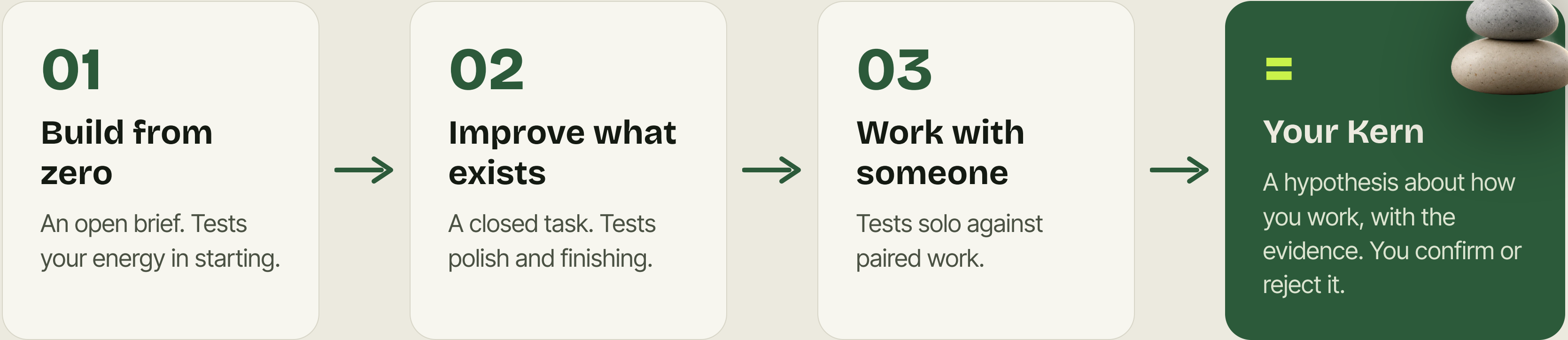
2026

AI changed who can make things

A beginner can now ship a real design, app or video in an afternoon. Doing real work is finally cheap enough to be how you explore.

THE SOLUTION

Three contrasting real missions end in *Your Kern.*



**AI is a smart friend,
not the author.**

You write your idea first. The co-pilot asks, unblocks and suggests next steps; it never hands you the answer. Missions are done twice, alone and with AI, to keep ideas your own.

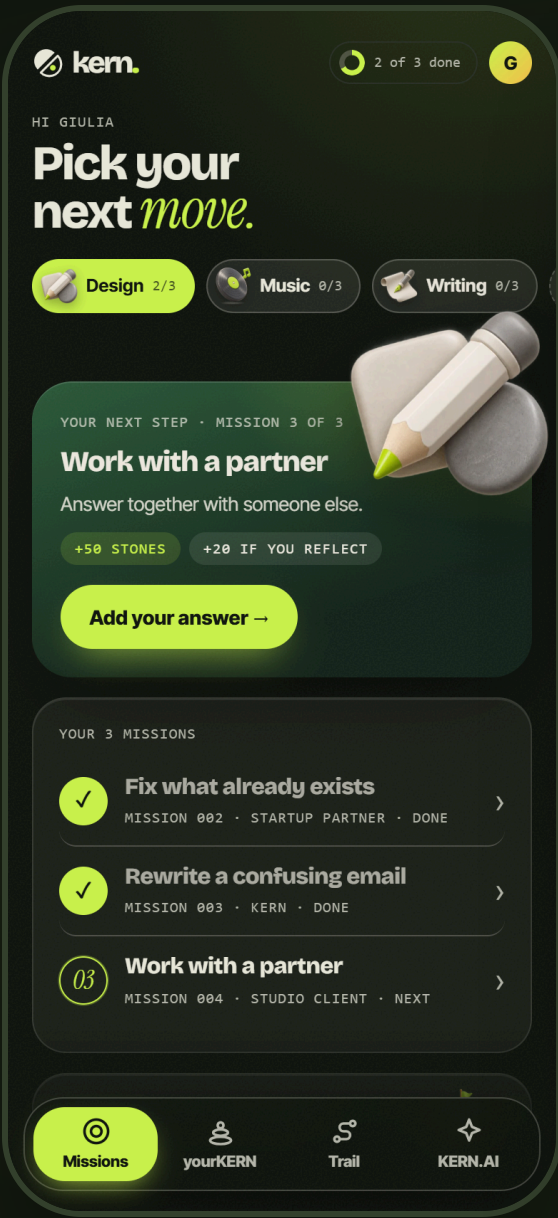
THE PRODUCT

It already *works*.

Designed and built by Manuel with AI tools.

- Installable web app
- English and Italian
- Accounts and sync
- Explore several paths
- Signs from people before you
- Dare a friend
- Shareable Kern card
- Works offline

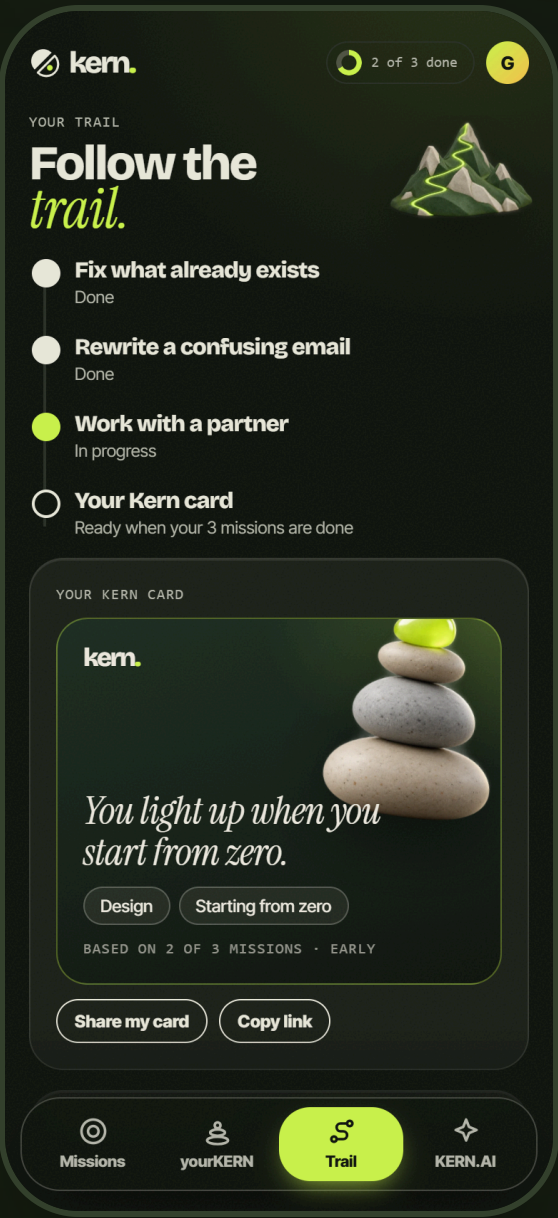
Installable and working, not launched publicly yet.
Missions are samples until partners join.



Missions



yourKERN



Trail

MARKET

Bottom-up, Italy alone is a first market of about *€33M a year*.



ITALIAN FIRMS WITH 10 TO 249 PEOPLE

212k

ISTAT 2023. Plus 100 universities (MUR/ANVUR).

SAM · FIRMS THAT HIRE GRADUATES, AND UNIVERSITIES

≈ €33M / yr

About 10.6k firms × €3k a year for 3 missions, plus 100 universities × €10k. Bottom-up estimate.

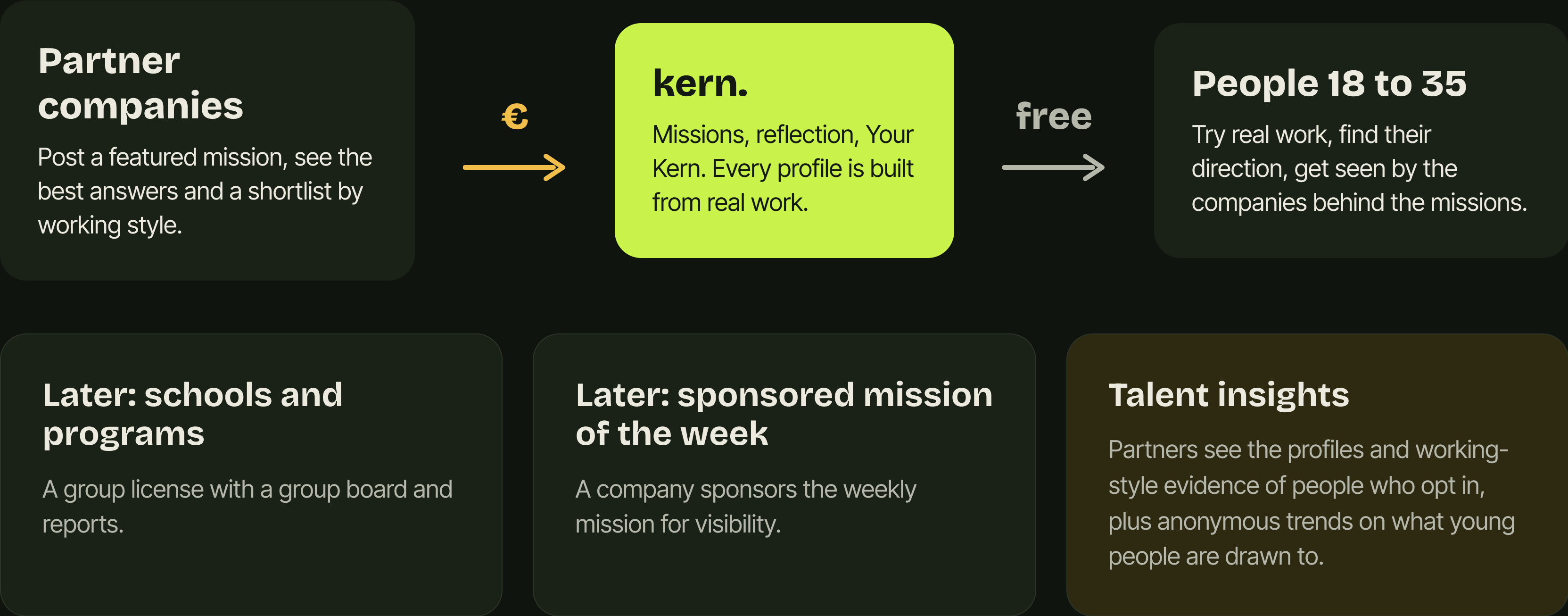
SOM · IN 3 YEARS

≈ €550k ARR

150 partner companies and 10 universities.

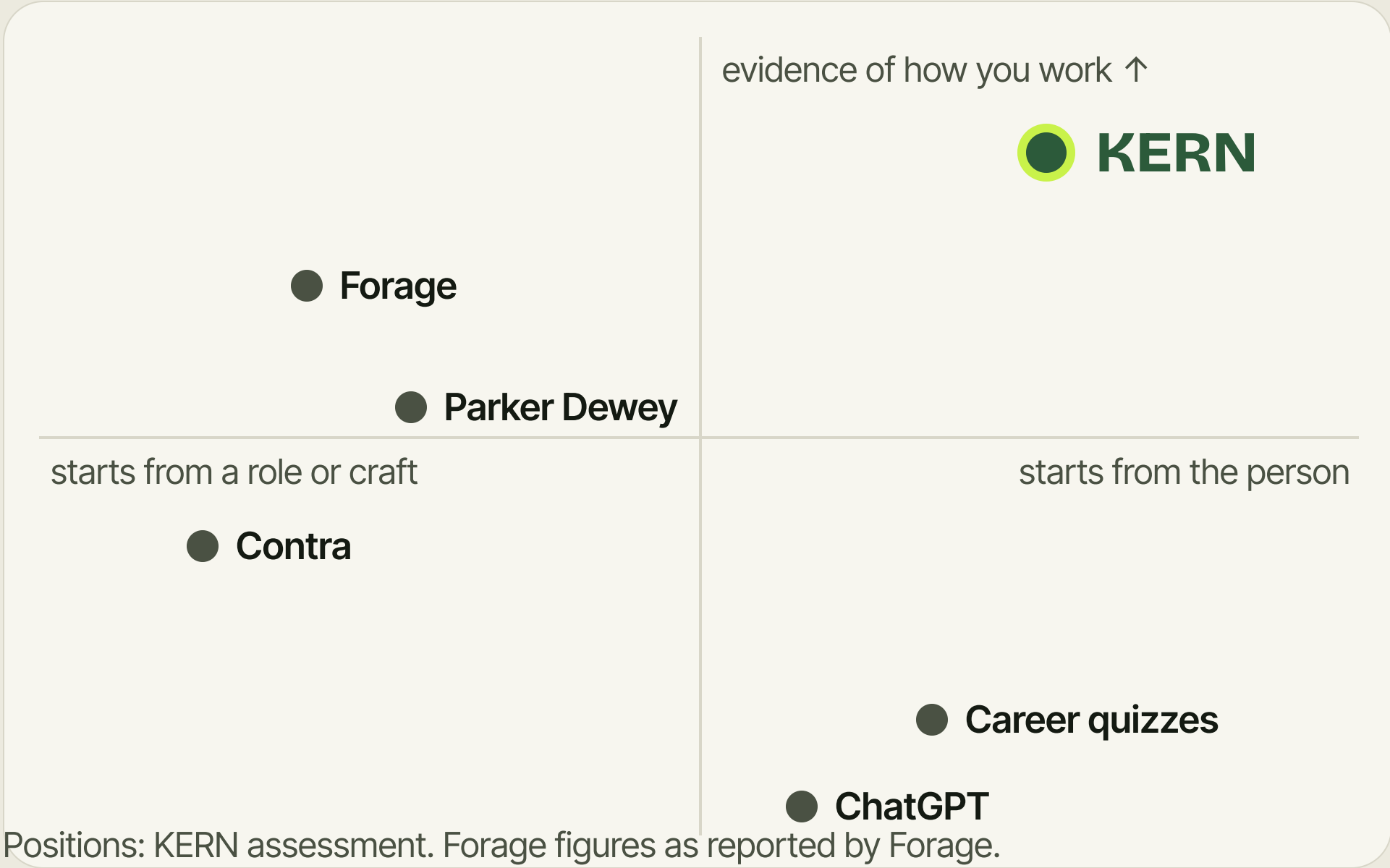
BUSINESS MODEL

Partners pay. *People are free.*



COMPETITION

Nobody starts from “*I don’t know what I want.*”



Forage (2M+ learners) and **Parker Dewey** prove companies will supply real tasks. They start from a role you already chose.

Quizzes and chat AI start from you, but you make nothing, so there is no evidence.

KERN is the person-first loop on top of real work.

VALIDATION

We test before *we build more.*



GATE 0 · STARTING SOON

Pilot

People outside the family, co-pilot played by hand.



GATE 1 · NEXT

Instrumented test

About 10 strangers, one link each, all logged.



GATE 2 · THEN

Co-pilot in the app

Real AI co-pilot, first partner missions.



GATE 3 · LATER

Signals and trails

AI-written signals with evidence.

3/5

finish all three missions

Pass mark for Gate 0.

3/5

say “that feels right”

The signal lands.

2/5

recommend it unprompted

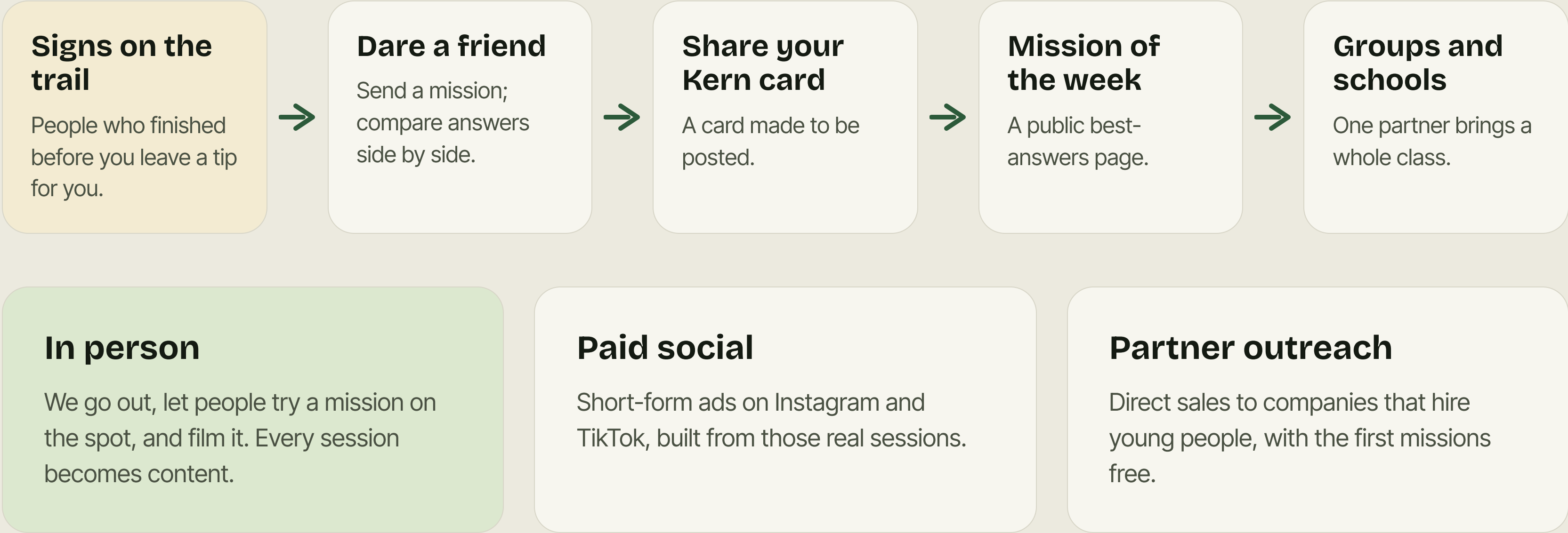
They pass it on.

Pilot results

Starting soon. As soon as it ends, we share finish, fit and referral rates.

GO TO MARKET · AGES 18 TO 35 FIRST

Growth is built into *the product*.



FOUNDER

One founder who ships *fast with AI*.



Manuel Di Paolo

FOUNDER · PRODUCT, DESIGN AND BUILD

Designed and built all of KERN with AI tools. Background in psychology: studies how people decide, then builds for it. Lived the problem first-hand. Works fully remote.

33

GitHub repositories created since 10 Sep 2026

1

working app: KERN, installable, EN and IT, accounts and sync

29/30

average across 110 university credits in psychology

THE ASK

€50k

Pre-seed · 12 months · 15% equity

The product is built. This round proves demand: 45% goes straight into growth. 15% at a €333k post-money is an early-believer price, with a clear step up to the seed round.



USE OF FUNDS

Growth: street sessions, paid social, partner outreach	€22.5k · 45%
Founder at minimal pay, 12 months	€7.5k · 15%
Legal: company, trademark, GDPR, accountant	€7.5k · 15%
Product, hosting and AI	€5k · 10%
Contingency	€7.5k · 15%

WHAT IT BUYS

- 1,000 people finish all three missions
- Half of starters finish; 30% come back within 60 days
- 15 partner companies, 5 of them paying
- 2 university pilots or letters of intent